

Table of Content

Part 1 The Rules

China's Retirement Age Policy: A Gendered Design
Retirement Age Is Not Universally Gendered
Why Retirement Age Exists — and Where Tension Emerges
When Formal Rules Shape Organizational Outcomes
Where Rules Meet Informal Adaptation

Part 2 The Mechanism

Career Horizon Compression
Promotion Timing and Leadership Accumulation
Rational Adaptation Under Constraint
From Rule to Outcome

Part 3 Stakeholder Consequences

How the Same Rule Produces Different Rational Responses
Shorter Horizons, Compounded Losses
When Talent ROI Becomes Uneven
Policy Leakage and Credibility Trade-offs
Key Implication

Part 4 Data and Evidence

Retirement Age Is Not Globally Settled
Longer Working Lives Without Zero-Sum Effects
Accumulation, Not a Single Rule
Participation Is Not Employment Saturation
important limits

Part 5 Synthesis and Strategic Use

Retirement Age Is a Structural Rule, Not a Technical Adjustment
Seeing the Mechanism Without Predicting Outcomes
Temporal Rules as a Hidden Driver of Inequality
What This Analysis Claims — and What It Does Not

Part 6

References and Data Sources
About the Author